

Winston Chou

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EMPLOYMENT

Netflix

New York, NY

Staff Research Scientist, AI Strategy & Innovation

2022 –

- Designed north star metric used to decide all personalization A/B tests. Awarded Best Paper at [KDD '25](#).
- Developed methodology and AI-based workflows for causal inference ([ECML PKDD '26](#), [Netflix](#)).
- Led experimentation to inform and optimize Netflix's \$15bn content budget ([IJIO](#)).
- Promoted from Senior (L5) to Staff (L6) in 2024.

Apple

New York, NY

Staff Data Scientist, AIML

2020 – 2022

- Designed, executed, and analyzed the first A/B tests on the Siri voice assistant.
- Wrote statistical software to analyze experiments on 250m+ devices.
- Promoted from Senior (ICT4) to Staff (ICT5) in 2021.

Facebook

New York, NY

Research Scientist, Statistics & Privacy

2018 – 2020

- Drove statistical models of missing data in advertising measurement from R&D to launch.
- Partnered with global engineering teams to implement statistical models in production.

EDUCATION

Princeton University

Princeton, NJ

PhD, Political Science

2019

SKILLS

- *Causal inference and experimentation.* Experiment design and analysis, experimentation platforms, meta-analysis, causal machine learning, observational causal inference
- *Statistics and machine learning.* Regression analysis, hierarchical models, Bayesian statistics, maximum likelihood estimation, missing data, variance reduction, data visualization
- *Statistical computing.* Python, R, Spark, SQL, Stan, PyMC

SELECTED RESEARCH

- [1] [“Estimating representative causal effects with double machine learning,”](#) with Apoorva Lal. *European Conference on Machine Learning & Principles and Practice of Knowledge Discovery in Databases (ECML PKDD '26)*.
- [2] [“The value of personalized recommendations: Evidence from Netflix,”](#) with Kevin Zielnicki, Guy Aridor, Aurélien Bibaut, Allen Tran, and Nathan Kallus. Accepted to *International Journal of Industrial Organization*. Presented at *NBER Digital Economics and AI Meeting* and *ACM Conference on Economics and Computation '26*.
- [3] [“Evaluating decision rules across many weak experiments,”](#) with Colin Gray, Nathan Kallus, Aurélien Bibaut, and Simon Ejdeymyr. *KDD '25: Proceedings of the 31st ACM SIGKDD Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining*. **Best Paper Award (Applied Data Science)**. [Netflix TechBlog post](#).
- [4] [“Learning the covariance of treatment effects across many weak experiments,”](#) with Aurélien Bibaut, Simon Ejdeymyr, and Nathan Kallus. *KDD '24: Proceedings of the 30th ACM SIGKDD Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining*. [Netflix TechBlog post](#).